CSE0001 – DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT ASSIGNMENT REPORT

PROJECT TITLE: STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR PORTFOLIO

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PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The primary objectives of this project were:

- To master visual communication by designing an educational infographic on digital literacy.
- To establish a professional digital identity using industry-standard platforms (GitHub, LinkedIn).
- To explore collaborative and technical environments (Kaggle) to prepare for career opportunities in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning.
- To refine digital communication skills by analysing and correcting common professional correspondence errors.
- To promote digital safety through the study of cybercrime prevention strategies.

TASK 1: TO CREATE THIS INFOGRAPHIC

I used **Canva** (canva.com), a free browser-based design tool that offers ready-made templates, drag-and-drop elements, icons, and custom colour palettes — making it accessible even without a graphic design background.

My design is a single-page visual resource divided into four color-coded sections covering: useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. A bold header defines what digital literacy means, and each section uses icons, pill-style labels, and short tips to keep information easy to scan. I chose a warm paper-toned background with teal, coral, blue, and purple accents so each topic feels distinct but visually connected.

One thing I found genuinely interesting was deciding *how much* information to include. Canva makes it tempting to keep adding elements, but I had to keep reminding myself that a good infographic communicates at a glance — not a scroll. Stripping content down to only what was essential, while still making it visually engaging, was the real design challenge.

TASK 2: BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

Overview

This task involved creating a digital portfolio using **GitHub** and **LinkedIn** to showcase skills, projects, and academic achievements effectively.

Implementation

- **GitHub:** I set up a profile and added a customized README.md file to detail my technical interests, skills, and future goals.
- **LinkedIn:** I updated my profile to reflect my academic background and specific career interests in **Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Machine Learning (ML)**.

Reflection

This task highlighted the importance of **personal branding**. While deciding which information to prioritize was a challenge, the process significantly improved my ability to organize a professional narrative.

TASK 3: EXPLORE CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

Platforms Used: HackerRank and Google Forms.

Reflection: To fulfil the technical requirements of Module 3, I engaged with HackerRank to complete a beginner-level Python challenge. This exercise was crucial in understanding the "Competitive Programming" environment that is standard for technical interviews in India. It taught me how to handle standard input/output and pass various test cases under a time constraint. For the collaboration component, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" via Google Forms. I designed exactly five questions that test a user's knowledge of password strength, phishing URLs, and cloud-based collaboration tools. I also linked this to a Google Sheet to experience the real-time data collection process. These tools are academically vital because they facilitate seamless group work. In my future engineering projects, the ability to collect peer feedback via Forms and practice logic on HackerRank will be the difference between a theoretical understanding and practical application. Mastering these cloud-based tools ensures that I am prepared for the collaborative nature of the modern tech workforce.

TASK 4: PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION & ETIQUETTE

Scenario Analysis: One significant challenge in the digital age is the "Professional-Personal Blur." I researched a hypothetical scenario where a student used their personal "gamer" email ID and informal slang to request an internship. The email was immediately disregarded by the HR department because it lacked a formal subject line and professional tone. This highlights that poor digital communication is often interpreted as a lack of seriousness or maturity. By drafting the two professional emails in this task one for an assignment extension and one for an internship inquiry

Prevention and Best Practices

This issue could have been avoided by adhering to the following etiquette:

- **Clear Subject Line:** Briefly state the purpose of the email (e.g., "Request for Extension: [Course Name]").
- **Formal Greeting:** Use professional titles (e.g., "Dear Professor [Name]").
- **Concise Explanation:** Provide context and a specific request.
- **Professional Tone:** Maintain a polite and structured format to ensure clarity and a timely response.

TASK 5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS & PREVENTION

Case Study Focus: UPI and Online Payment Fraud.

Reflection: Researching UPI fraud was an eye-opening experience. I was surprised to discover how sophisticated "Social Engineering" has become. Scammers often pose as "Army Officers" or "Tech Support" to gain a student's trust before sending a "Collect Request" on apps like GPay or PhonePe. The most shocking revelation was the sheer volume of victims who lose money simply because they believe they must enter their PIN to *receive* a payment. As a Digital Ambassador, I have committed to changing my personal habits: I now use a separate, secondary account for UPI transactions and have shared the **1930 Helpline** with my family. This research has transitioned my perspective from "passive user" to "active defender" of my digital assets.

CONCLUSION

This project has been an essential milestone in my first year at VIT Bhopal. It has provided me with the tools to build, communicate, and protect my digital life. As I progress through my B.Tech, the GitHub repository I have created today will serve as the foundation of my professional journey.

REFERENCES

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